Deepak Kumar

Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics
Virginia Tech, 317 Hutcheson Hall
250 Drillfield Drive, Blacksburg, VA 24061

+1 (540) 824-8930
deepak21@vt.edu
dk.deep2711@gmail.com
deepakkumar0302.github.io

Education

Ph.D. in Economics (ABD), Virginia Tech	Expected May 2027
M.S. in Agricultural and Applied Economics, Virginia Tech	2025
M.A. in Economics, Jawaharlal Nehru University, India	2017
B.Sc. in Statistics, Hindu College, Delhi University, India	2015

Fields

Applied Microeconomics; Development Economics; Applied Econometrics

References

Anubhab Gupta (Chair)
Assistant Professor
Agricultural and Applied Economics
Virginia Tech
anubhab@vt.edu

Chi Ta
Assistant Professor
LBJ School of Public Affairs
The University of Texas at Austin
chi.ta@austin.utexas.edu

George Davis
Professor
Agricultural and Applied Economics
Virginia Tech
georgedavis@vt.edu

Job Market Paper

1. "From Strangers to Neighbors: Does Refugee-Host Integration Improve Local Economic Development?" [PDF]

Abstract: How do refugee-hosting arrangements shape the economic gains to host communities? We study the transition from encampment to inclusive hosting around an established refugee camp in Kenya. Combining monthly refugee population records with village-level nighttime lights from 2012 to 2024, we compare nearby and more distant host villages before and after the transition, supplemented by a triple-difference comparison with a hosting area that remained under encampment. Nighttime lights in nearby villages increased by approximately 33 percent on average, with larger effects in later phases of the policy. Household evidence shows gains in employment and real consumption, alongside higher enterprise ownership, while measured maize and goat prices show no detectable increase. The transition also changed the relationship between refugee numbers and host activity. A large refugee inflow under encampment generated no detectable differential response in nearby villages; after integration, this response became positive and substantial. These findings suggest that the economic benefits of hosting refugees depend on the opportunities hosts have to serve refugee demand.

Publications

2. "Governance Response during COVID-19 and Political Affirmative Action: Evidence from Local Governments in India"
   with Vivek Pandey and Ankita Rathi
   Public Administration and Development, 2023 [PDF]
3. "COVID-19, Information Management by Local Governments, and Food Consumption"
   with Vivek Pandey and Shyam Singh
   Food Policy, 2022 [PDF]
4. "Performance Assessment of Dairy Cooperative Societies: An AHP-Based Composite Index Approach"
   with Goutam Sutar, Rakesh Arrawatia, Krantiraditya Dhalmahapatra, and Ashish Garg
   Annals of Operations Research, 2022 [PDF]
5. "Impact of Gendered Participation in Market-Linked Value Chains on Economic Outcomes: Evidence from India"
   with Vivek Pandey and Hari K. Nagarajan
   Food Policy, 2021 [PDF]

Working Papers

6. "A Gendered Approach to Economic Impacts of Refugee Assistance"
   with Anubhab Gupta, Justin Kagin, and J. Edward Taylor
   Revise and Resubmit, *World Development* [PDF]
7. "Local Economic Disruptions: Evidence from Administrative Electricity Data and Night-Time Lights"
   with Chi Ta and Anubhab Gupta [PDF]
8. "Food Vulnerability during Shocks and Women's Bargaining Power: Evidence from Indian Cooperatives"
   with Vivek Pandey, Hari K. Nagarajan, and Harpreet Singh
   [PDF]
9. "Adoption of Agricultural Technologies by Smallholder Farmers: A Synthesis of Empirical Evidence"
   with Miki Khanh Doan
   World Bank Group working paper, 2025 [PDF]

Work in Progress

10. "Refugee Integration and Host Resilience to Weather Shocks: Evidence from Kenya"
11. "Cost of Inaction: Impacts of Reduced Food Assistance on Welfare Outcomes in Somalia and Uganda"
    with Anubhab Gupta, Tao Qi, Justin Kagin, J. Edward Taylor, and Siddharth Krishnaswamy
12. "Fertility and Schooling Responses to a Girl-Child Transfer in India"
13. "Sustainable Agriculture Promotion and the Spread of Crop Residue Burning in India"

Scholarship of Teaching and Learning

14. "Is AI a Substitute or Complement to Learning? A Randomized Controlled Trial among College Students"
    with George Davis [PDF]
15. "Making Classroom Observations Count: Lessons from a Graduate Teaching Scholar Program"
    Teaching Tip, submitted to *NACTA Journal*

Teaching Experience

Virginia Tech

Instructor, AAEC 3204: International Agricultural Development and Trade (Fall 2024)

30 students; median student evaluation 5/6, 100% response rate

Co-Instructor (Teaching Assistant), AAEC 1005: Economics of the Food & Fiber System (Fall 2025)

Principles of microeconomics; 120 students; taught one-fourth of the lectures

Teaching Assistant, AAEC 3204: International Agricultural Development and Trade (Fall 2022, Fall 2023)

Institute of Rural Management Anand (IRMA), India

Instructor, Stata for Econometric Methods for Impact Evaluation (Fall 2019)

MBA course; 80 students

Pedagogical Training

Graduate Certificate, Future Professoriate, Virginia Tech 2026

Graduate Teaching Scholar (GTS), Virginia Tech 2023–2026

Competitive three-year fellowship in pedagogy, curriculum design, classroom observation, peer evaluation, and teaching-and-learning scholarship. Includes coursework, one-on-one mentoring, and conference participation.

Policy Reports

1. "The Cost of Inaction: Impacts of WFP Assistance Shortfalls on Food Security Outcomes in Somalia." United Nations World Food Programme. [Link]
2. "The Cost of Inaction: Impacts of WFP Refugee Assistance Shortfalls on Food Security Outcomes in Uganda." Partner agency: United Nations World Food Programme. [Link]
3. "Sustainability of Dairy Cooperative Societies under the National Dairy Plan I." Evaluation report. National Dairy Development Board, India, and the World Bank. [Link]

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Virginia Tech 2021–present

Consultant, Poverty Global Department, World Bank May–Jun 2025

Research Fellow, Verghese Kurien Policy Lab, IRMA 2020–2021

Research Associate, Verghese Kurien Policy Lab, IRMA 2018–2020

Grants	ReCIPE Research Grant, CEPR (PI), $15,000, submitted	2026
	Virginia Tech Graduate Research Development Program Grant (PI), $1,000	2024
Awards and Honors	Joseph Frank Hunkler Memorial Scholarship, Virginia Tech	2026–2027
	NACTA Doctoral Student Teaching Award	2026
	UC Davis Summer School in the Economics of Migration (full funding)	2026
	AAEA Travel Grant, Virginia Tech	2025
	AERE Summer Conference Travel Scholarship	2024
	NAREA Student Scholarship	2024
	GPSS Travel Grant, Virginia Tech	2022–2025
Presentations	AAEA Annual Meeting	2023, 2024, 2025
	AERE Summer Conference	2024
	Virginia Association of Economists Annual Meeting	2024
	GPSS Research Symposium, Virginia Tech	2024
Service	Referee: *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*	
	Graduate Student Seminar Chair, Virginia Tech	2023–2024
Skills	Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, GAMS, Google Earth Engine, Git Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (native), Bhojpuri (native), Oriya (beginner)	
Personal Information	Citizenship: Indian, F-1 student	